HAONING LI

PhD Candidate in Applied Linguistics, School of the Arts, Queen Mary University of London
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EDUCATION

PhD in Applied Linguistics, Queen Mary University of London — expected 2027
Thesis title: *Recontextualising Ergodic Character Gameplay Practice: A Social Semiotic Analysis of Character-Centric Discourse in Gacha Game Interface Interactivity*
Supervisors: Agnieszka Lyons; Nelya Koteyko
Thesis status: final stage of writing-up

Master of Translation and Interpreting, Beijing International Studies University — 2021
Areas of focus: Game Localisation; Translation of Multimodal and Multimedia Texts

BA in English, Nanjing University of Finance and Economics — 2018
Area of focus: English–Chinese Translation

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Digital Interfaces and Interactivity; Fandom and Popular Culture; Game Studies; Game Translation and Localisation; Media and Communication; Discourse Analysis; Multimodality; Social Semiotics; Applied Linguistics

AWARDS

Research Support Award, School of the Arts Research Committee, Queen Mary University of London — 2025–26

Research Support Award, School of the Arts Research Committee, Queen Mary University of London — 2024–25

Outstanding Master's Student Award, Beijing International Studies University — 2019–21

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles and Book Chapters

Li, H. (in press). Gaming as public communication of humanistic knowledge. In G. Reid, C. Anson, & X. Tan (Eds.), *The Routledge handbook of humanities and social science communication*. Routledge.

Li, H. (in press). Negotiating story and character: A social semiotic analysis of gacha game official video thumbnails. *Languages in Global Contexts*. University of Toronto Press.

Li, H. (2022). An analysis of translation subjectivity and transformation of translator identity in game localisation. *Overseas English*, (13), 13–14, 22. [In Chinese]

Abstracts in Conference Proceedings

Li, H. (2025). Genre or not: Examining the "-like" suffix as an emergent category expression [Abstract]. In *Abstract proceedings of Chinese DiGRA 2025: Video games in museums*. Digital Games Research Association. https://doi.org/10.26503/dl.v2025i4.2769

Li, H. (2025). Understanding transmedia character-centric discourse in gacha games: A social semiotic analysis of *Genshin Impact* [Abstract]. In *Abstract proceedings of DiGRA 2025: Games at the crossroads*. Digital Games Research Association. https://doi.org/10.26503/dl.v2025i3.2556

PRESENTATIONS

Under Review

Li, H. (2027, June 2–4). *Bringing interactivity onto the canvas: Annotating character-centric interfaces in games* [Paper presentation]. 13th International Conference on Multimodality (13ICOM), Helsinki, Finland.

Li, H. (2027, February 25–26). *Building with glitches: How players make semiotic resources from malfunction* [Paper presentation]. Pop Cultural Linguistics 2027: Researching and Theorizing Performed Language and Communication, Lecce, Italy.

Presented

Li, H. (2026, July 1–3). *Recontextualising character progression: A social semiotic analysis of gacha game interface interactivity* [Paper presentation]. 34th European Systemic Functional Linguistics Conference (ESFLC 34), Gothenburg, Sweden.

Li, H. (2025, November 20–21). *Genre or not: Examining the "-like" suffix as an emergent category expression* [Paper presentation]. Chinese DiGRA 2025: Video Games in Museums, Shanghai, China.

Li, H. (2025). *Understanding transmedia character-centric discourse in gacha games: A social semiotic analysis of* Genshin Impact [Paper presentation].

- 50th International Systemic Functional Congress and Institute (ISFC 50), Glasgow, United Kingdom, July 7–11, 2025.
- DiGRA 2025: Games at the Crossroads, Valletta, Malta, June 30–July 4, 2025.

Li, H. (2024, May 2). *A social semiotic approach to character-driven game design in gacha games* [Paper presentation]. Linguistics Postgraduate Research Afternoon 2024, Queen Mary University of London, London, United Kingdom.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Associate, Queen Mary University of London, London, United Kingdom

- **EAL4710 Reading and Writing Critically**, Department of International Education — Autumn 2026
  Module convenor: Charlotte Assimakopoulos

- **EAL4205 Excellence in Academic Writing 1**, Department of International Education
  Module convenor: Luis Carabantes — Autumn 2026
- **LIN5206 Applying Linguistics in the Real World**, Department of Linguistics, School of the Arts
  Module convenor: Agnieszka Lyons — Spring 2025

Language Tutor (Mandarin Chinese), Speaking Practice Team, School of the Arts, Queen Mary University of London, London, United Kingdom — 2024 – 2026

Lecturer, Tangshan Vocational & Technical College, Tangshan, China — 2021 – 2023

- **College English**
- **Career Guidance**

TEACHING QUALIFICATIONS

Associate Fellow of the Higher Education Academy (AFHEA), Advance HE — 2026

Certificate in Learning and Teaching (CILT), Queen Mary University of London — 2026

Teacher Qualification Certificate (Higher Education), Ministry of Education of the People's Republic of China — 2022

RELATED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Translator (part-time), Toplingual Service Co., Ltd., Beijing, China — 2020 – 2021

Translator (part-time), Eagle Eye Translation Service Co., Ltd., Shanghai, China — 2019 – 2020

SERVICE

Volunteer (host, logistics and event support), Guest Speaker Seminar Series, Department of Linguistics, School of the Arts, Queen Mary University of London, London, United Kingdom — 2026

Volunteer (logistics and event support), Confucius Institute, Queen Mary University of London, London, United Kingdom — 2024 – 2025

Volunteer (translation and support), First China Public Policy Translation Forum, Beijing, China — 2019

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Digital Games Research Association (DiGRA)
British Association for Applied Linguistics (BAAL)

LANGUAGES AND SKILLS

Languages: Chinese (native); English (fluent); Japanese (basic)
Digital skills: ELAN; NVivo; LaTeX; Python; R